

USTC Discovery: Research Plan

Sealing Cases and Documents - 10/19/2021

This research will take place during [sprint number] October 20, 2021 - November 2, 2021	
Related Story	Other Notes
Story 8998 Story 4251	

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Overview & Purpose

Background information on why this research is needed

The purpose of this research is to engage with USTC docket clerks to better understand their experiences with sealing and unsealing cases and documents and to identify opportunities for improvement. USTC stakeholders have prioritized 2 stories at this time which outline the following objectives:

Story 8998: Seal and unseal cases and documents - User Research

- Understand user workflows and usability concerns related to sealing and unsealing cases and documents.

Story 4251: Docket Clerk - Unseal a case

- Inform the workflow, design, and usability of the unsealing process for entire cases/legacy cases only.

Research Goals

Overall aim or vision to outline the purpose of our work

1. **Understand and document the unique perspectives, needs and experiences of Docket Clerks**
2. **Define key moments in the user's experiences to identify opportunities to improve the sealing and unsealing process**
3. **Create an enhanced user experience across DAWSON'S sealing and unsealing process**

Guiding Questions

Overarching "big picture" questions we want to answer through this research

* These questions will not be asked directly to users. Interview guide is outlined below.

- What are users expectations when sealing/unsealing cases and documents?
 - What do users need and value?
 - How can we make it easier for users to complete their tasks?
- How does sealing/unsealing cases and documents integrate into a larger workflow?
- How have users done this in the past?
- What challenges and opportunities are there with this process?
 - What areas of the UI impact their experience most?
 - How should we prioritize our improvements?

Research Methods

How we will approach our research to gather the information we need

- 1:1 non-standardized interviews
 - Duration of 30 minutes
 - Scheduled remotely via zoom

Engagement Groups

A list of people we will speak with to learn more about their experiences

In order to gather diverse perspectives from people that utilize DAWSON, we will meet with 3-5 users with representation from the following category:

Interviewee Participants	
User Type	Approx. # of participants
Docket Clerk	3

Recruitment Email

Email template for scheduling interviews with participants

Subject: Sealing/Unsealing Cases Feedback Interview

Hi _____

Our team is currently seeking to better understand the processes around sealing and unsealing cases and documents at the U.S. Tax Court and would like to invite you to give your feedback. The purpose of this research is to form a better understanding of your challenges with sealing and unsealing cases/documents and more specifically to identify ways to improve this process. If you are interested, I would like to schedule a 30-minute discussion with you via Zoom and get your thoughts and feedback. If you are interested in participating, please schedule a time with me at <https://calendly.com/flexion-recruiting-ux/ustc-sealing-unsealing-interview>

Please let me know if none of these times work for you. Thank you, we greatly value your feedback and time.

Regards,
Lia

Interview Guide

Questions we will reference to guide our conversations with users

Intro Script

Hello! My name is _____. I am a UX Researcher working with U.S. Tax Court and I want to thank you for agreeing to spend time with me today.

As we mentioned in the invitation, Flexion is designing a tool for the U.S. Tax Court to allow Docket Clerks to seal and unseal cases and documents online. As part of this process, we're gathering feedback from Docket Clerks to help inform our designs. We are interested in learning more about your processes around some specific features.

Participation in this interview is completely voluntary and optional, you can terminate the session at any time for any reason. Your responses are confidential, when the findings are reported they will be aggregated and anonymized so that nothing that is said can be tied directly to you.

Please note that we are performing this research to validate ideas and features of the platform, and we are not testing you as a participant. Feel free to be as open and candid as you would like and don't hold back your opinions. You will not hurt anyone's feelings.

Would it be okay if we record our conversation for note-taking purposes? Your feedback will be kept entirely anonymous and will only be used internally for note-taking purposes.

Does that sound good? Any questions before we get started?

Introduction

- To start, can you tell us a little about yourself and what you do?
 - What is your current role with the Tax Court? Any previous roles?
 - How long have you been with the Tax Court?
- Tell me a little bit about your experience with sealed cases. (Blackstone and DAWSON)
 - How often do you encounter sealed cases?
 - How do you interact with sealed cases?
 - How does it compare to how you interact with unsealed cases?

Sealing and Unsealing Cases

- Describe a time when you were involved in sealing a case.
 - What are you doing when this happens?
 - What do you need to do?
 - How do you know when your work is done?
 - Any issues?

- Describe a time when you were involved in unsealing a case.
 - What are you doing when this happens?
 - What do you need to do?
 - How do you know when your work is done?
 - Any issues?

Sealing and Unsealing Documents

- Tell me about your experience with sealed documents. (Blackstone)
 - How often do you encounter sealed documents?
 - What does a sealed document look like?
 - How do you interact with sealed documents?
 - How does it compare to how you interact with unsealed documents?
- Describe a time when you were involved in sealing a document.
 - What are you doing when this happens?
 - What do you need to do?
 - How do you know when your work is done?
 - Any issues?
- Describe a time when you were involved in unsealing a document.
 - What are you doing when this happens?
 - What do you need to do?
 - How do you know when your work is done?
 - Any issues?

Conclusion

- What do you like the most about the sealing and unsealing process? The least?
- If you could have anything you wanted to make sealing and unsealing easier, what would you ask for?
- Is there anything else you would like to share?

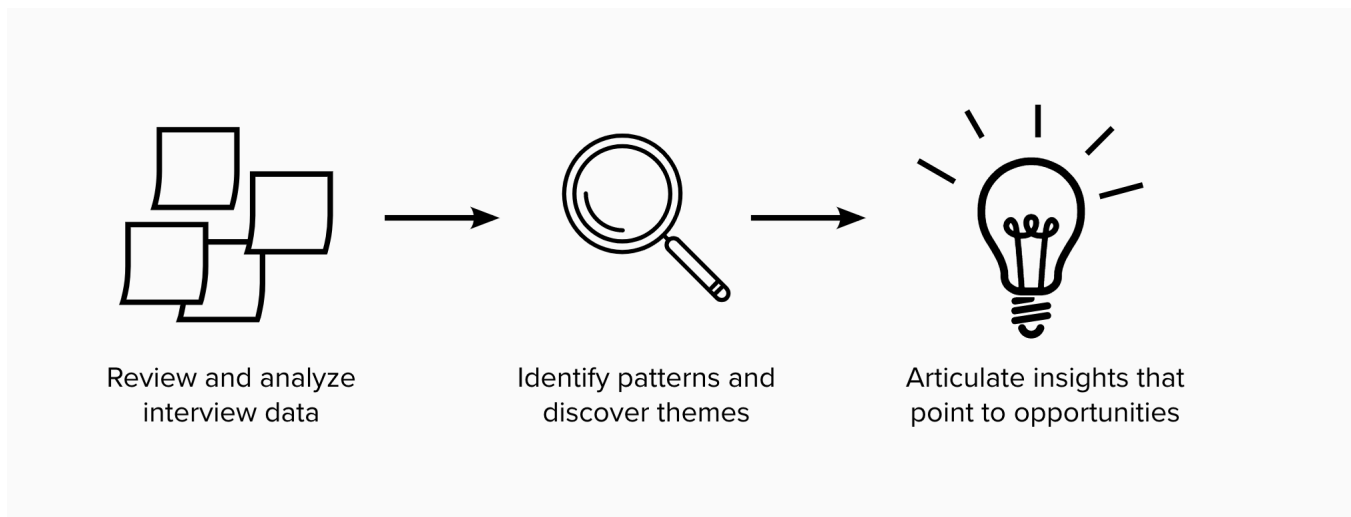
Synthesis Process

[Overview of how we will synthesize interview data](#)

Our team will utilize affinity mapping to synthesize our interview data and research.

- Data and first-hand accounts from interviews will be transformed into stickies in Mural
- All interview data will be anonymized by a unique participant ID
- Similar stickies will be grouped by theme to uncover insights about the user experience

- Human-centered insights will serve as the foundation for opportunities to improve DAWSON



Outcomes

What will come out of this research

The research gathered from the Docket Clerks will uncover human-centered insights that will serve as the foundation to inform the future design and functionality of DAWSON's sealing and unsealing process for cases and documents online.